VanijLiquor

Customer Portal - User Guide

The self-service portal for VanijLiquor customers. Onboard a business, choose a plan, modules and billing term, get a live price quote, then issue a signed, machine-bound licence and activate it on the counter PC. Every feature is illustrated with a real screenshot of the running portal.

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Prepared for: shop owners, onboarding staff and the licensing team

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How to use this guide

Every feature is written the same way: a small table of **who** it is for, **where** it lives in the menu, and **what** it is for, followed by numbered steps, any notes, and a **where this lives** table that names the API routes behind the screen. Each feature ends with one or more screenshots of the running portal.

Conventions
Menu paths use a dash, for example **Onboard - Plans & Pricing**.
Values you type or pick are shown in monospace, for example `VL-LIC-XXXXXX`.
Money is shown in rupees; the portal adds **GST 18%** on top of the plan price.

Run the portal and load the demo data

Start the portal and, optionally, reset it to the demo dataset before you explore:

```
npm start
npm run seed-demo
```

What the demo dataset contains
Three businesses: `Shree Wines & Co` (Premium, 3 years), `Madhushala Bar & Restaurant` (Standard, 1 year) and `Ganesh Liquor Mart` (Basic, monthly).
One licence per business, each activated on its own machine fingerprint.
Codes in the legacy style: `VL-2026-0001` and up.
MRR of `Rs 3,197` from the three active businesses.

Ports and commands
Backend: `127.0.0.1:7200`. Web UI: `http://127.0.0.1:8081`.
Other scripts: `npm test` (33 tests), `npm run reset-db`, `npm run gen-license-key`, `npm run screenshots` (rebuild this guide's images).

Part A - Getting started

What the Customer Portal is

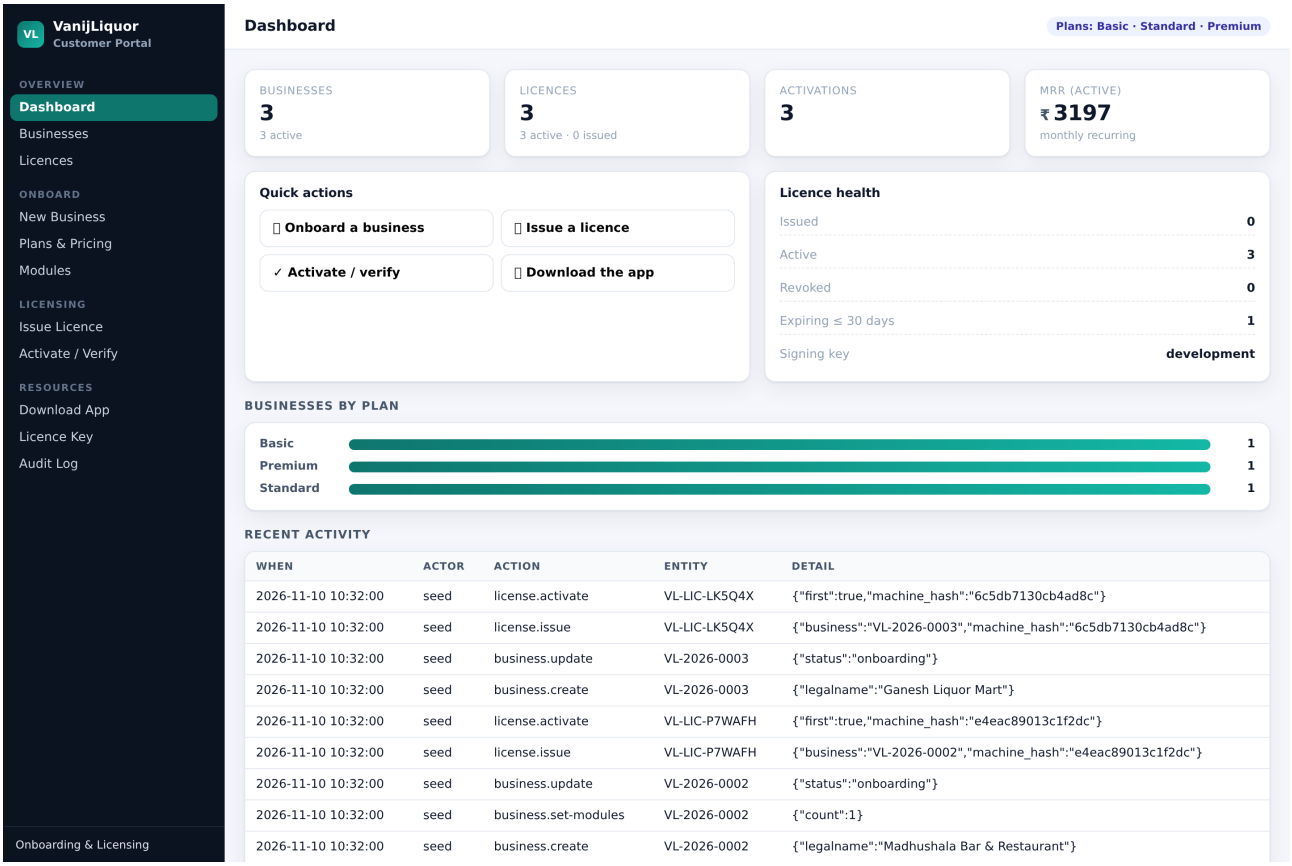
Who	Everyone
Where	Open the portal URL in a browser
What for	The portal is the self-service front door for VanijLiquor: a shop onboards itself, picks a plan and modules, gets a price quote, and receives a machine-bound licence it can activate on the counter PC.

1. The portal is a web app. Open it in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox).
2. It runs as two small services: a backend API and a web front end that serves the UI and proxies `/api` to the backend.
3. Start everything with `npm start` from the `new_code_portal` folder.
4. The portal opens on the **Dashboard**; use the left sidebar to move between screens.

> **Notes**
> There is no login on the portal in this build — it is an operator/vendor console. Put it behind your own authentication (reverse proxy or VPN) before exposing it.
> Backend listens on `127.0.0.1:7200`; the web UI on `0.0.0.0:8081`.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Start the portal	npm start (backend :7200 + web :8081)



The portal shell: the sidebar menu on the left, the page on the right.

The layout: sidebar, top bar and toasts

Who	Everyone
Where	Any screen
What for	Learn the common furniture so every screen is easy to read.

1. The **sidebar** groups the screens: **Overview** (Dashboard, Businesses, Licences), **Onboard** (New Business, Plans & Pricing, Modules), **Licensing** (Issue Licence, Activate / Verify) and **Resources** (Download App, Licence Key, Audit Log).
2. The **top bar** shows the current screen name and a reminder of the three plans.
3. A **toast** (a small message, bottom of the screen) confirms or refuses every action, for example Issued VL-LIC-XXXXXX or an error.
4. On a narrow window the sidebar collapses behind the ☰ menu button.

> **Notes**
> Selecting a sidebar item changes the URL hash (for example `#plans`), so a screen can be linked or bookmarked.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Navigation	client-side routing in web/app.js (hash routes)

Part B - Overview

Dashboard

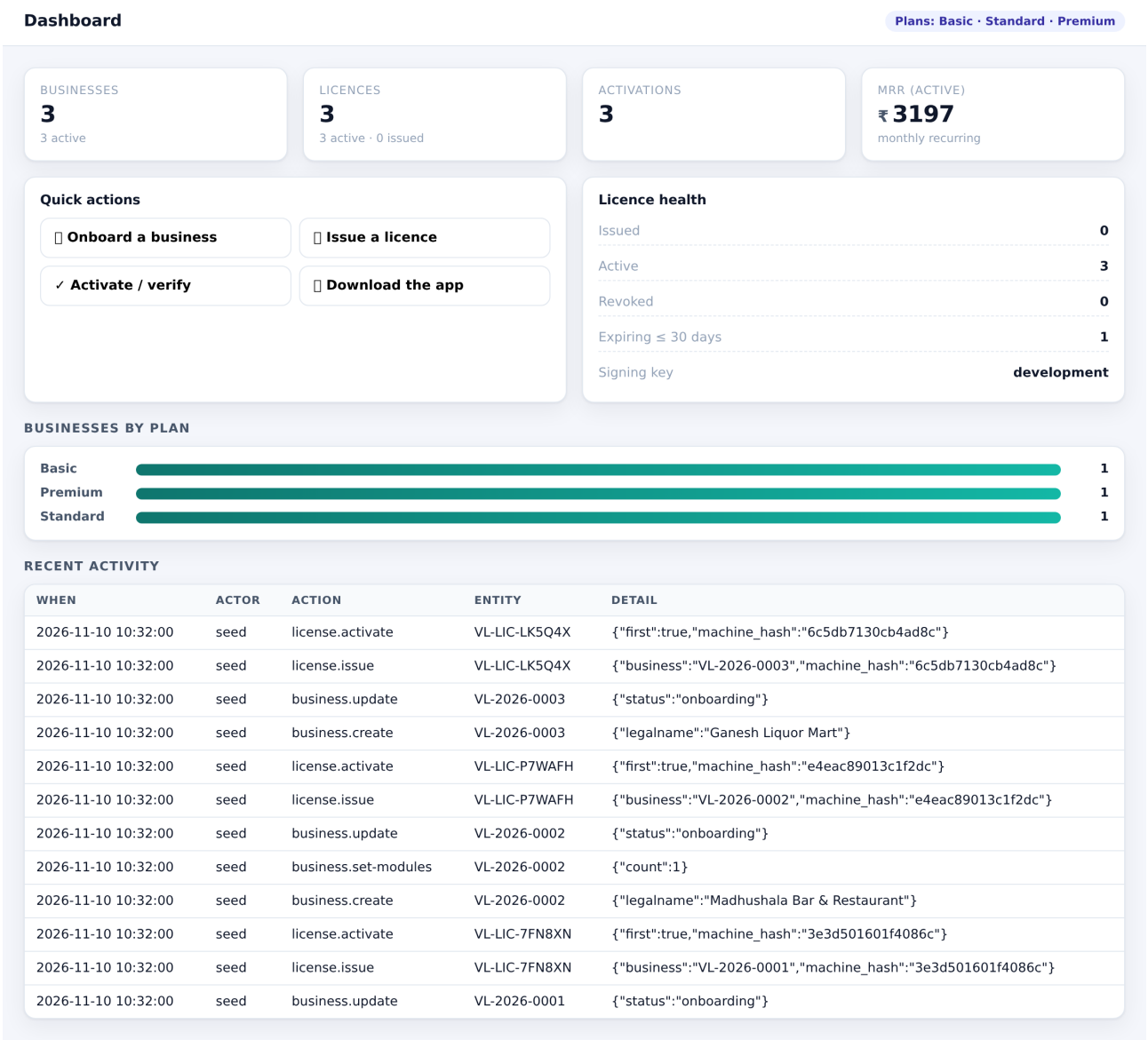
Who	Everyone
Where	Overview - Dashboard
What for	See the health of the whole book of business at a glance: how many shops, how many licences, activations and recurring revenue, plus the latest activity.

1. Open **Overview - Dashboard**. It is the default screen.
2. Read the four headline cards: **Businesses** (with how many are active), **Licences** (active / issued), **Activations** and **MRR** (monthly recurring revenue).
3. Use **Quick actions** to jump straight to **Onboard a business**, **Issue a licence**, **Activate / verify** or **Download the app**.
4. Read **Licence health**: issued, active, revoked, expiring within 30 days, and whether the signing key is production or development.
5. Scan **Businesses by plan** for the spread across Basic / Standard / Premium.
6. Read **Recent activity** — the last few audit events (business created, licence issued, licence activated, and so on).

> **Notes**
> **MRR** sums the monthly plan price of every active business, so a yearly customer still contributes their monthly-equivalent.
> If **Signing key** shows development, the licences are signed with the built-in dev key — set `PORTAL_LICENSE_KEY` before issuing real licences (see Part E).

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Dashboard cards, licence health, activity	GET /api/dashboard



Dashboard: businesses, licences, activations, MRR and recent activity.

Businesses (search and open)

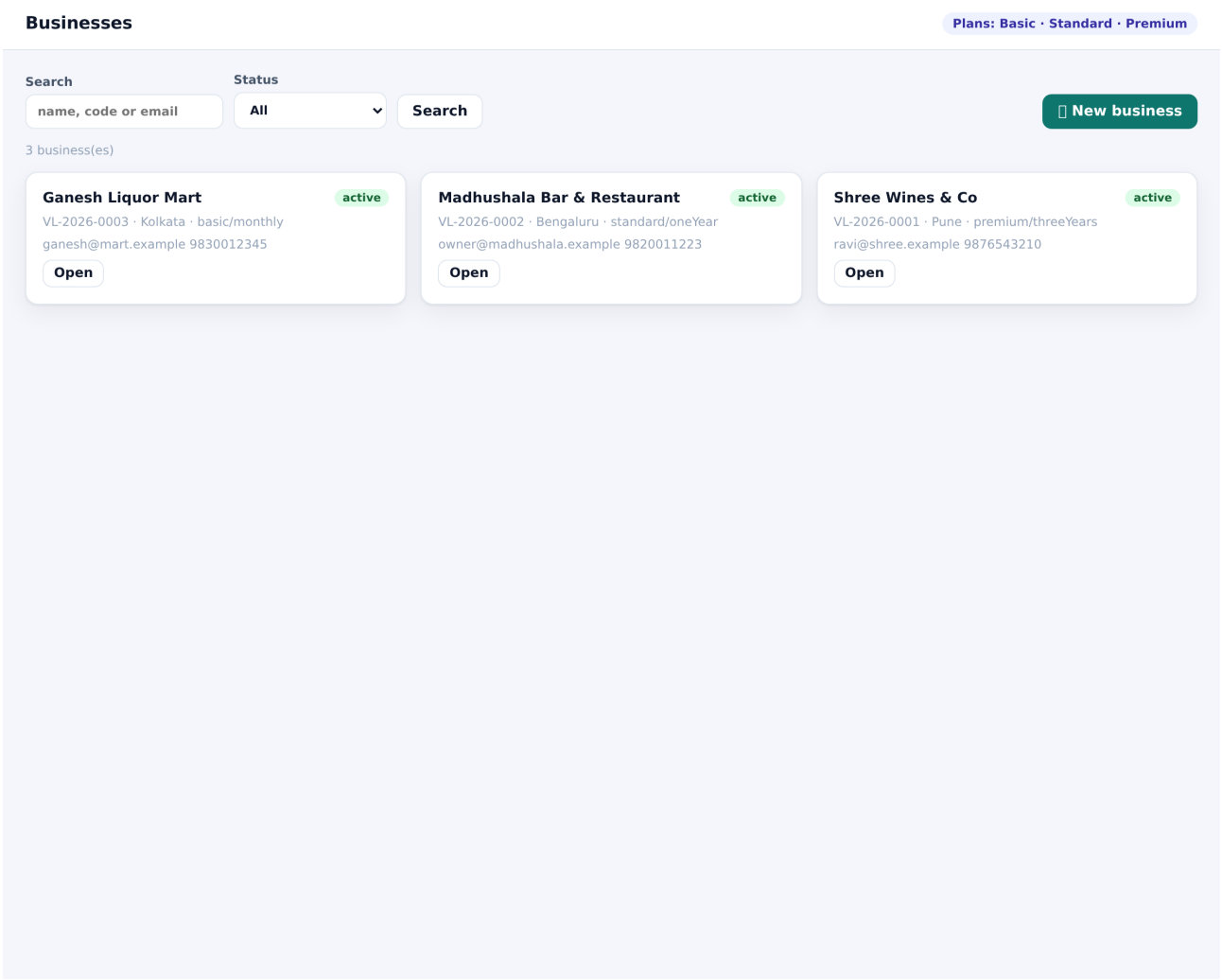
Who	Everyone
Where	Overview - Businesses
What for	Find a shop by name, code or e-mail, filter by status, and open its record.

1. Open **Overview - Businesses**.
2. Type in **Search** (matches legal name, code or e-mail) and/or pick a **Status**: draft, onboarding, active or suspended.
3. Select **Search**. The list shows one card per business with its status badge.
4. Select **Open** on a card to see the full record (see the next topic).
5. Select **New business** to start the onboarding wizard.

> **Notes**
> Every business gets a code in the legacy style `VL-YYYY-NNNN`, for example `VL-2026-0001`.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
List / search	GET /api/businesses?q=&status;=
Open one business	GET /api/businesses/:id



Businesses: search, status filter and one card per shop.

Business details (record, plan and licences)

Who	Everyone
Where	Overview - Businesses - Open
What for	See a single shop's details, its plan and entitled modules, and every licence issued to it — and issue a new licence or edit its modules from here.

1. Open a business from the Businesses list.
2. Read the **Business** card: code, legal and trade name, owner, e-mail, phone, GSTIN, city/state, business type, outlets and status.
3. Read the **Plan & entitlement** card: the plan, billing period and the module chips the shop is entitled to.

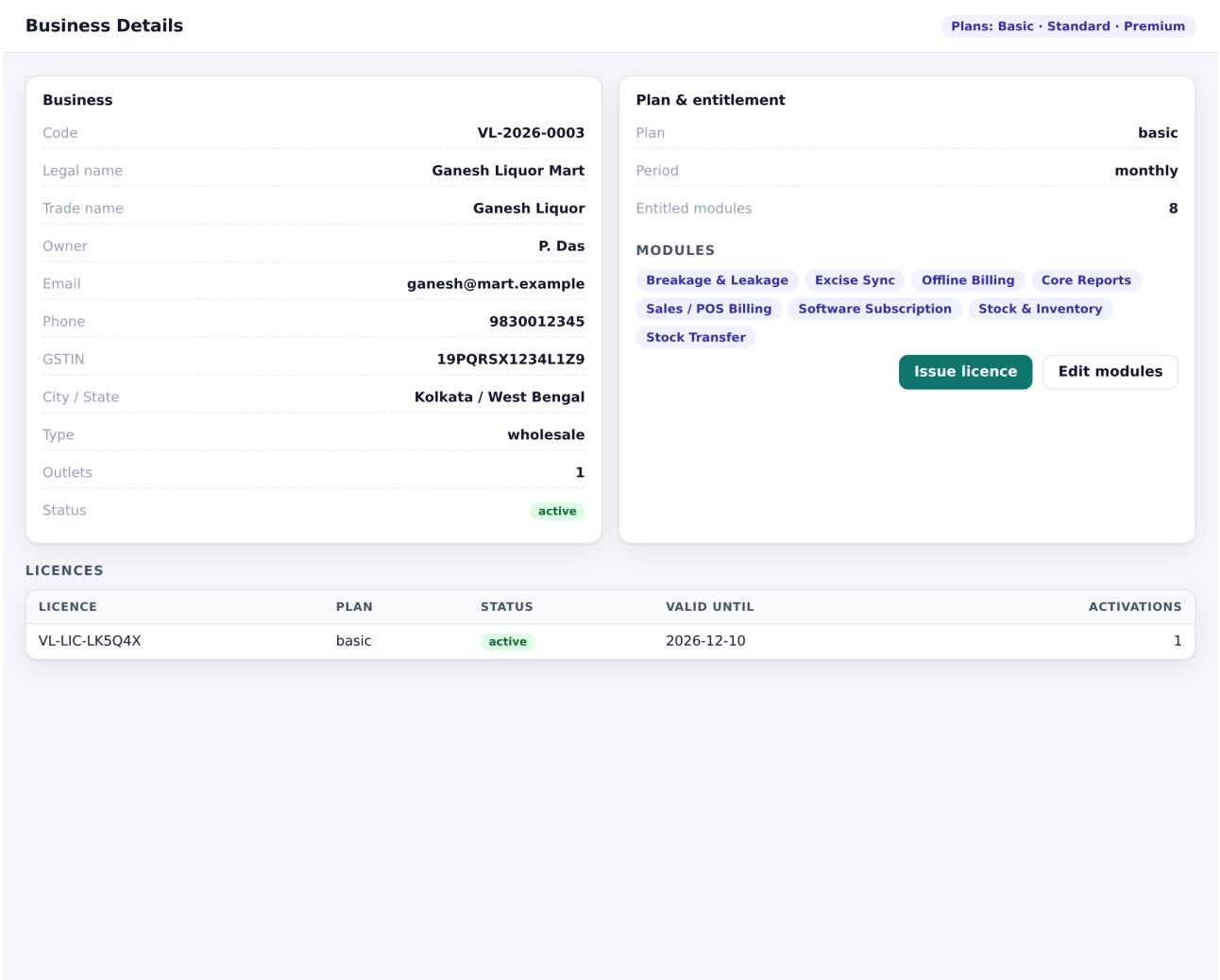
4 Select **Issue licence** to mint a licence for this shop, or **Edit modules** to change its entitlements.

5 Under **Licences** read every licence for the shop: id, plan, status, valid-until date and activation count.

> **Notes**
> Entitlements are the plan's bundled modules plus any extra modules you selected. They are copied into every licence you issue.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Business record	GET /api/businesses/:id
Change modules	POST /api/businesses/:id/modules
Licences for this shop	GET /api/licenses?business_id=:id



Business details: record, plan and entitlement, and its licences.

Licences (all issued licences)

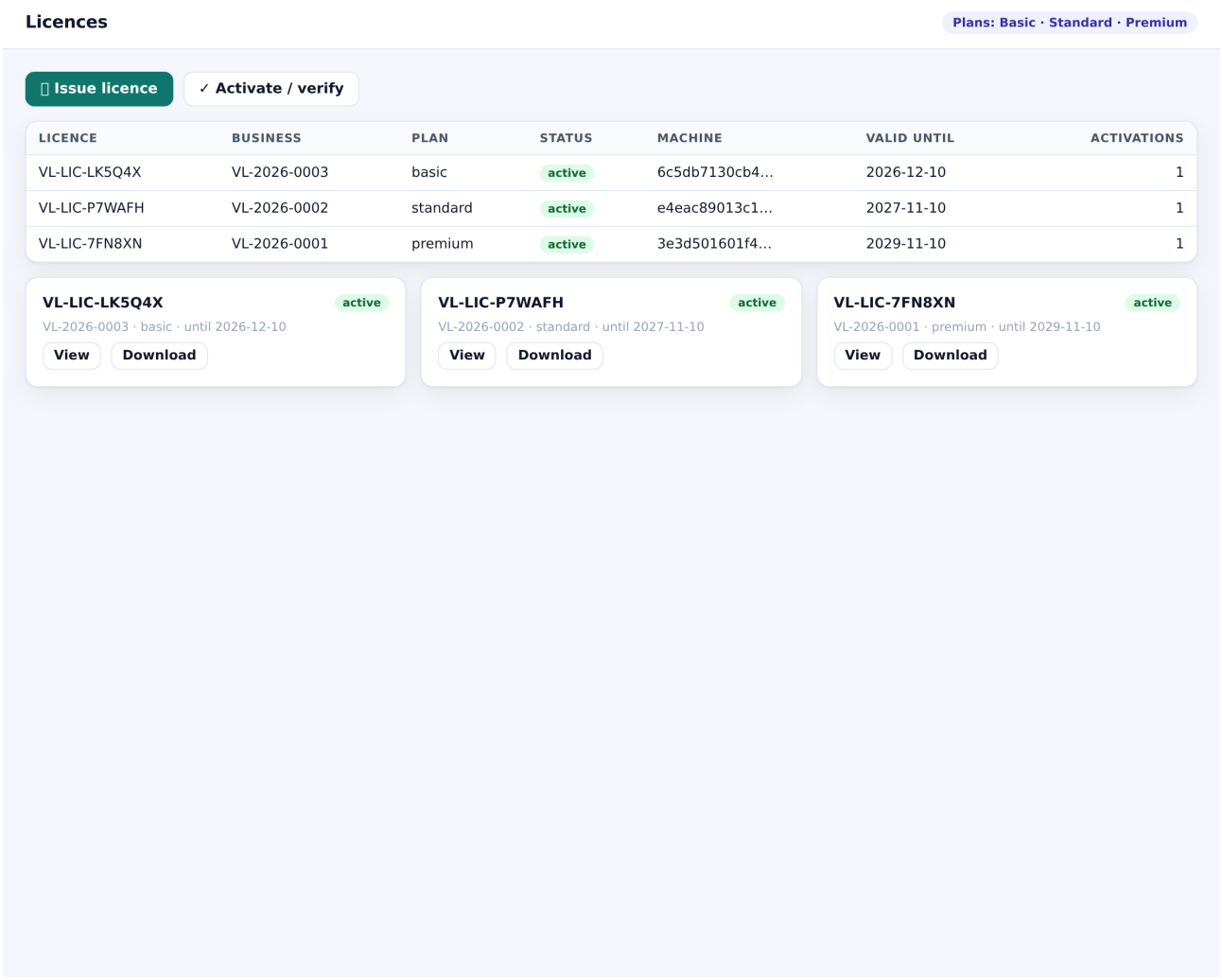
Who	Everyone
Where	Overview - Licences
What for	See every licence across all shops in one table, open one, or download its licence file.

1. Open **Overview - Licences**.
2. Read the table: Licence id, Business, Plan, Status, Machine (first 12 hex digits of the machine hash), Valid until and Activations.
3. Each licence also appears as a card below with **View** (opens the licence detail) and **Download** (saves the `.vlic` file).
4. Use **Issue licence** or ✓ **Activate / verify** to jump to those screens.

> **Notes**
> Statuses are **issued** (minted, not yet activated), **active** (activated on its machine) and **revoked** (withdrawn).

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
List licences	GET /api/licenses
Licence detail	GET /api/licenses/:id
Download .vlic	GET /api/licenses/:id/file



Licences: every licence, with View and Download on each card.

Part C - Onboard & pricing

Onboard a business (the wizard)

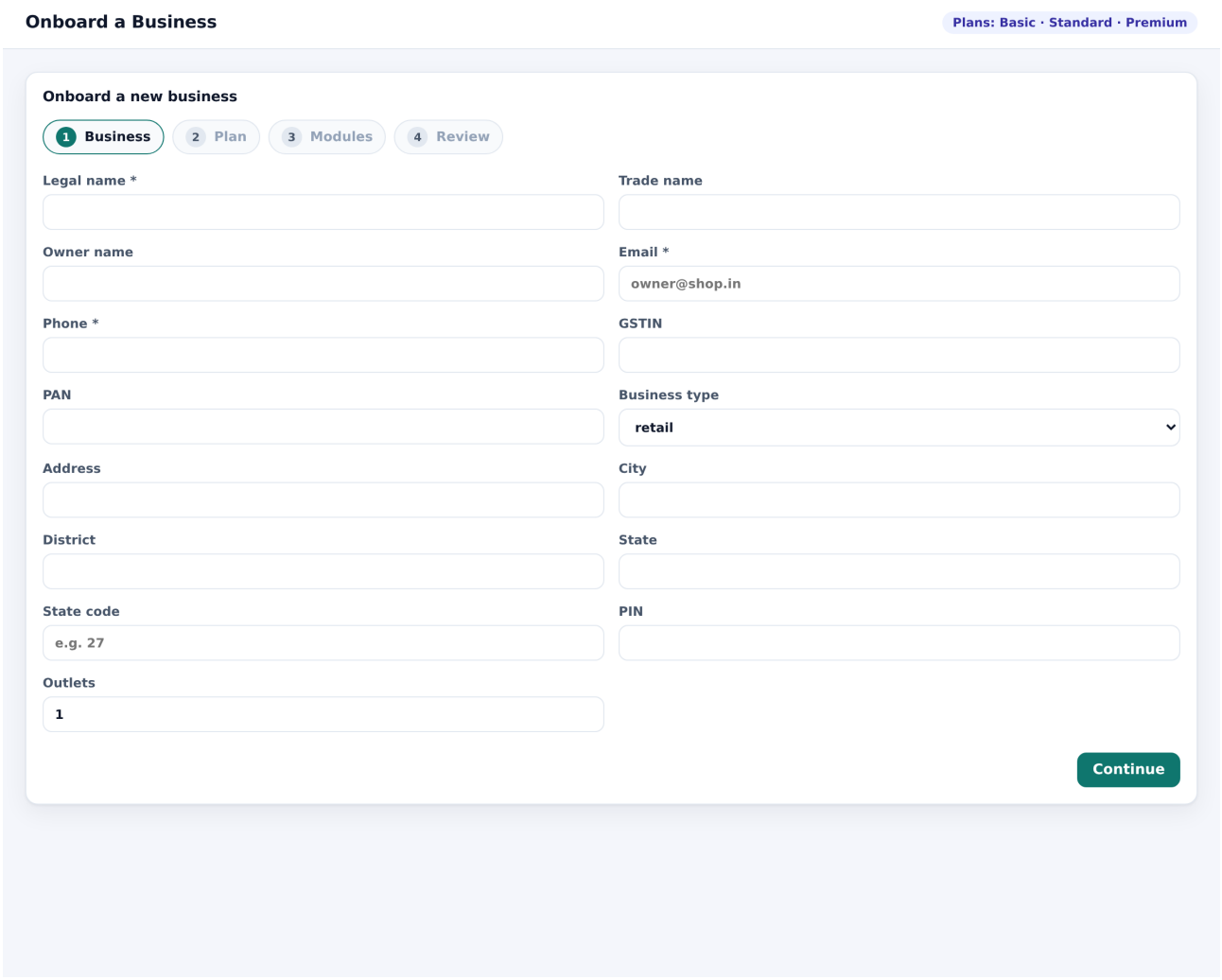
Who	Everyone
Where	Onboard - New Business
What for	Create a new customer in four steps: business details, plan and term, modules, then a review with the live price.

1. **Step 1 - Business.** Enter the legal name (required), trade name, owner, e-mail (required), phone (required), GSTIN, PAN, business type, address, city, district, state, state code, PIN and number of outlets. Select **Continue**.
2. **Step 2 - Plan.** Pick a plan (Basic / Standard / Premium) and a billing term (Month, 1 Year, 2 Years, 3 Years). The quote box updates as you choose. Select **Continue**.
3. **Step 3 - Modules.** Tick the modules the shop should have. Modules already in the plan are pre-marked included; extra modules are quoted as add-ons. Select **Continue**.
4. **Step 4 - Review.** Check the business summary and the subscription breakdown (base, add-ons, GST 18%, total), then select **Create business**.
5. On success the portal shows Created VL-YYYY-NNNN and opens the new business's detail page.

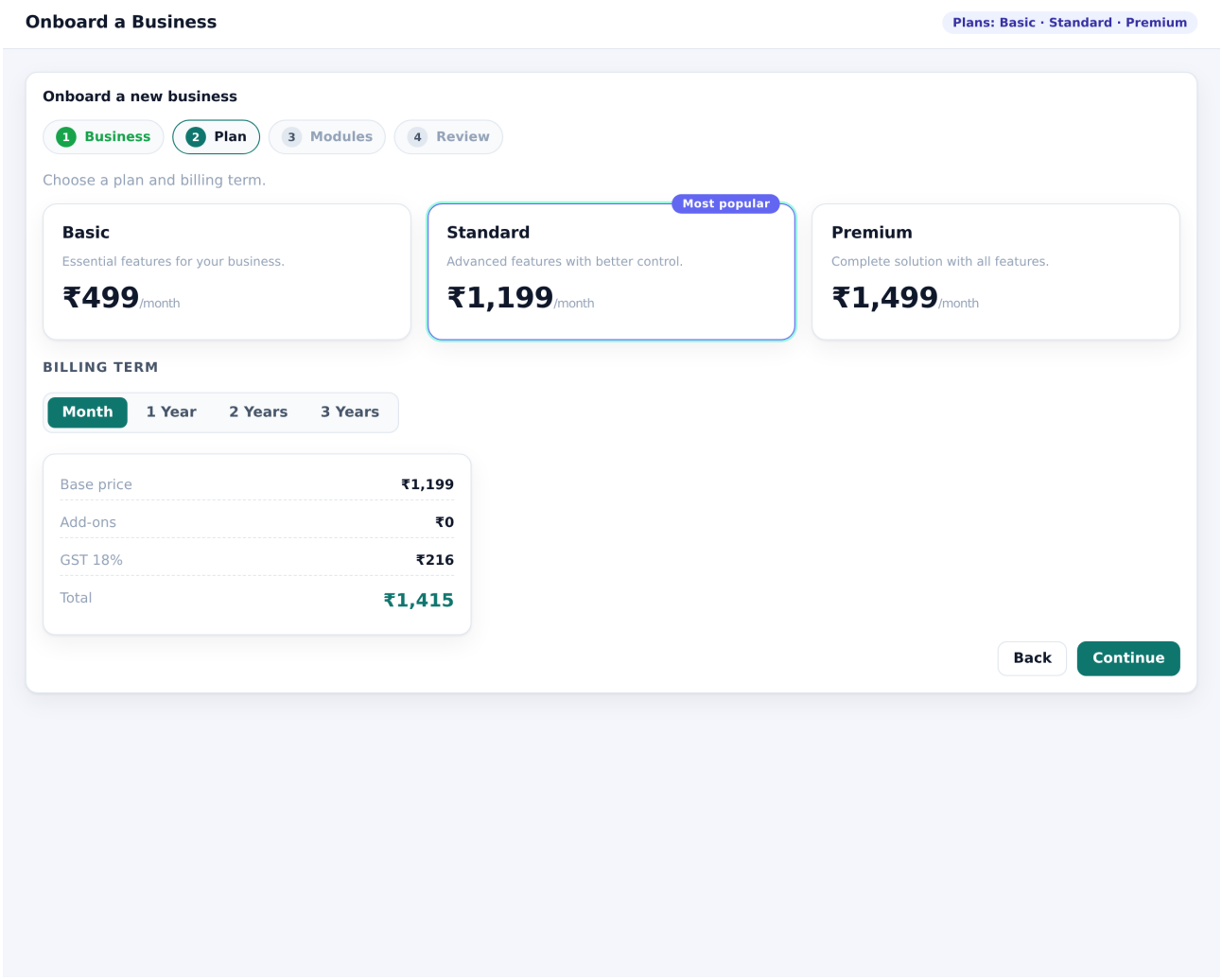
> **Notes**
> The legal name is required; the wizard will refuse to create without it.
> You can go **Back** at any step; your entries are kept.
> The price is a quote only — the portal does not take payment in this build.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

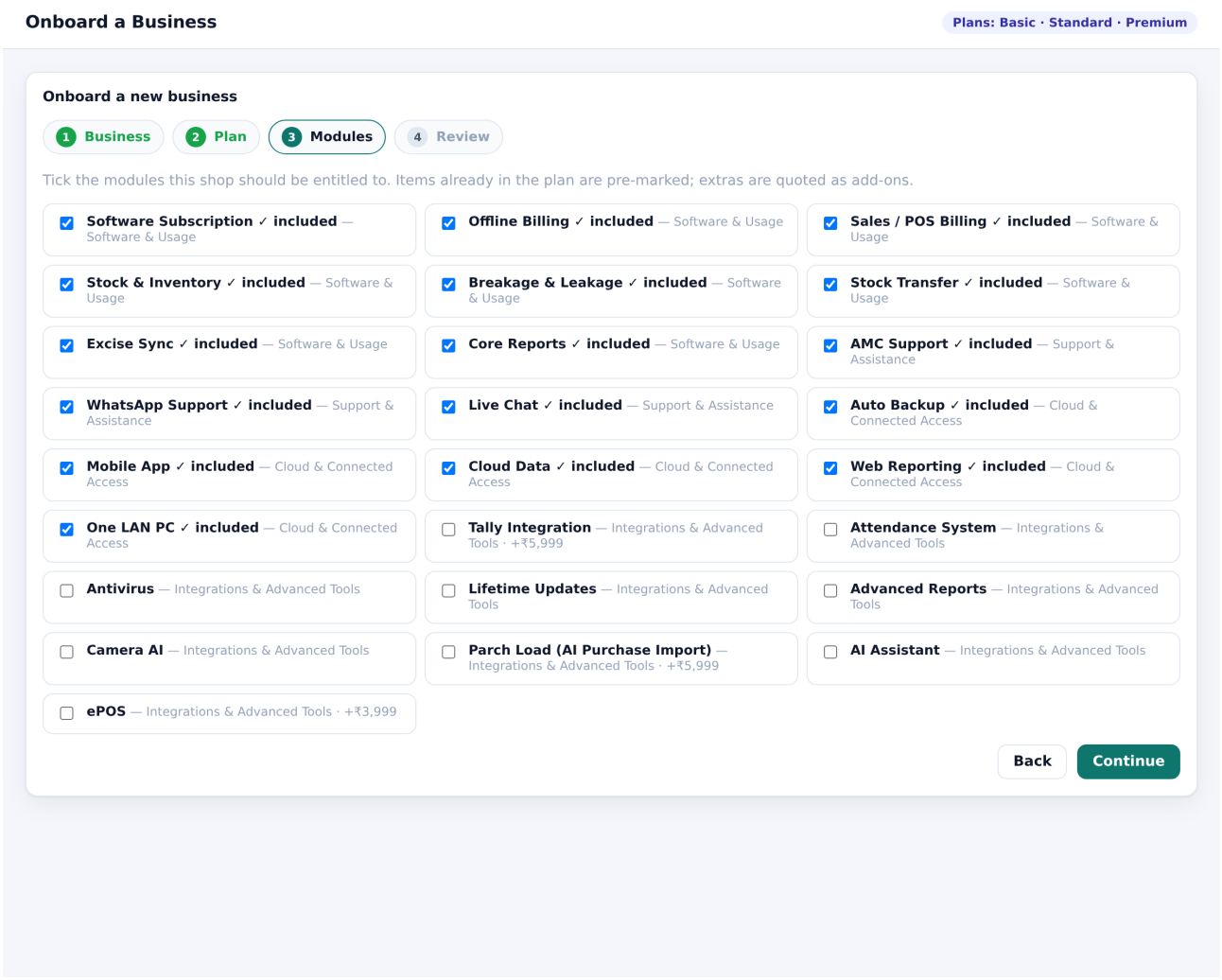
Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Create the business	POST /api/businesses
Set its modules	POST /api/businesses/:id/modules
Price a quote	POST /api/quote (or computed in the wizard)



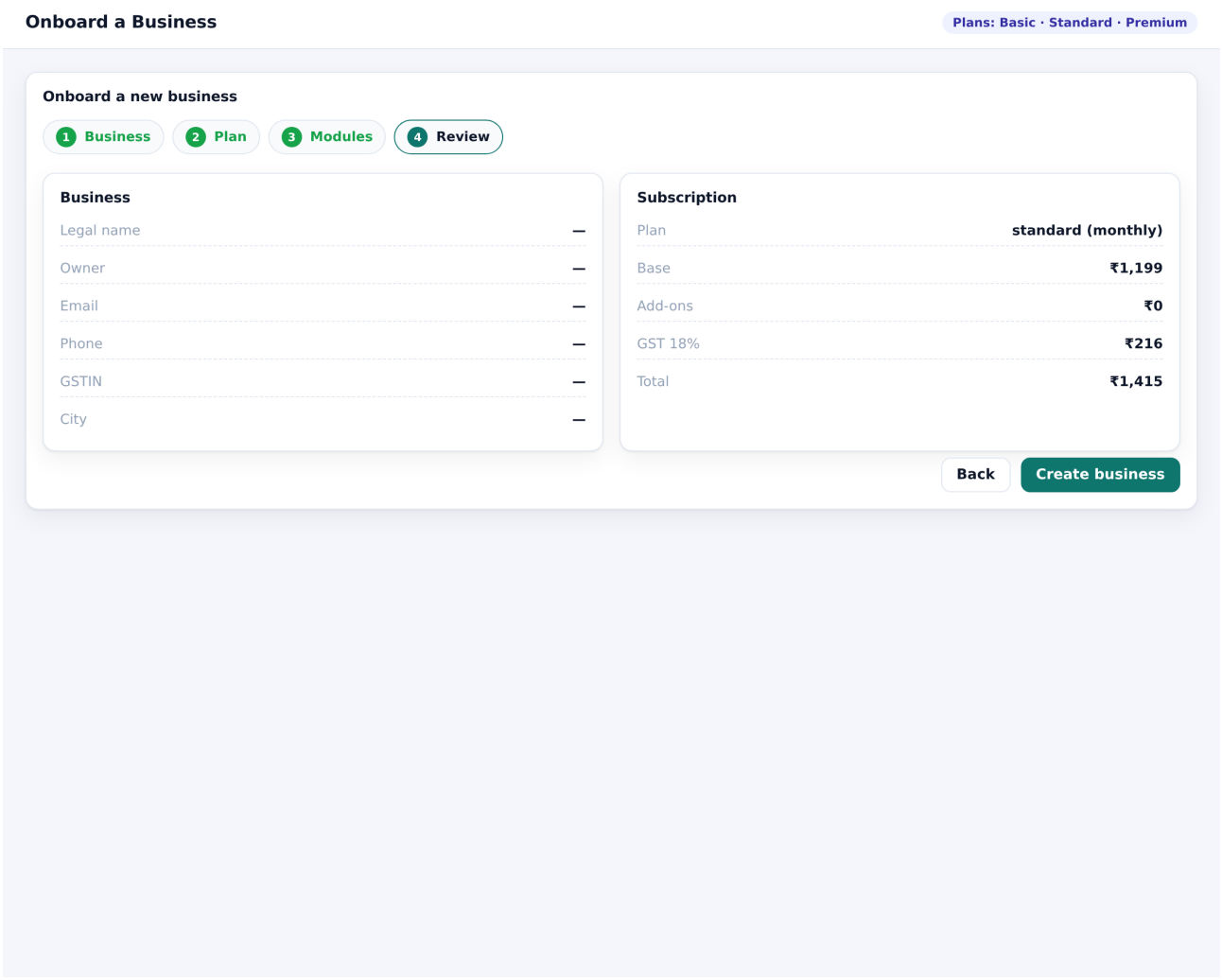
Step 1 - Business details.



Step 2 - Plan and billing term, with the live quote.



Step 3 - Modules; bundled ones are pre-marked.



Step 4 - Review and Create business.

Plans & Pricing

Who	Everyone
Where	Onboard - Plans & Pricing
What for	Show the three plans, their per-term prices, the feature comparison and the stand-alone add-ons.

1. Open **Onboard - Plans & Pricing**.
2. Use the term selector (Month / 1 Year / 2 Years / 3 Years) to re-price the cards.
3. Read each plan card: name, tagline, price for the chosen term and its highlights.
4. Read **Compare plans** — a feature matrix grouped by category, with a tick per plan.
5. Read **Add-ons** — the stand-alone extras and their prices.
6. Select **Choose <plan>** to start onboarding with that plan in mind.

> **Notes**
> Prices mirror the vendor's public subscriptions page and are stored in the database (the `plans`, `plan_prices` and `comparison` tables), so they can be re-priced without code changes.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Plans, prices, comparison, add-ons	GET /api/plans, /api/periods, /api/comparison, /api/addons

Plans & Pricing Plans: Basic · Standard · Premium

Month | 1 Year | 2 Years | 3 Years

Basic
Essential features for your business.
₹499/month
- ✓ Essential billing & stock control
- ✓ Excise management
- ✓ Offline usage
- ✓ Single counter

Choose Basic

Most popular

Standard
Advanced features with better control.
₹1,199/month
- ✓ Everything in Basic
- ✓ AMC & WhatsApp support
- ✓ Cloud data, backup & web reporting
- ✓ One LAN PC

Choose Standard

Premium
Complete solution with all features.
₹1,499/month
- ✓ Everything in Standard
- ✓ Tally integration
- ✓ Attendance & antivirus
- ✓ Advanced reports & AI assistant

Choose Premium

COMPARE PLANS

CLOUD & CONNECTED ACCESS

FEATURE	BASIC	STANDARD	PREMIUM
Auto Backup	—	✓	✓
Mobile App	—	✓	✓
Cloud Data	—	✓	✓
Web Reporting	—	✓	✓
One LAN PC	—	✓	✓

INTEGRATIONS & ADVANCED TOOLS

FEATURE	BASIC	STANDARD	PREMIUM
Tally Integration	—	—	✓
Attendance System	—	—	✓
Antivirus	—	—	✓
Lifetime Updates	—	—	✓
Advanced Reports	—	—	✓

SOFTWARE & USAGE

FEATURE	BASIC	STANDARD	PREMIUM
Software Subscription	✓	✓	✓
Offline Usage	✓	✓	✓

SUPPORT & ASSISTANCE

FEATURE	BASIC	STANDARD	PREMIUM
AMC Support	—	✓	✓
WhatsApp Support	—	✓	✓
Live Chat	—	✓	✓

ADD-ONS

ADD-ON	DETAIL	PRICE	PERIOD
Cloud	Cloud access and connected data services.	₹7,999	Yearly
WhatsApp	WhatsApp-related integration and support.	₹3,999	Yearly
Tally	Automatic Tally accounting synchronisation.	₹5,999	Yearly
Purchase Import	Purchase import functionality (one-time).	₹5,999	One-time
LAN PC	Additional LAN-connected computer.	₹5,999	One-time
ePOS	Electronic POS functionality.	₹3,999	One-time

Plans & Pricing: cards, the comparison matrix and add-ons.

Modules & Add-ons catalogue

Who	Everyone
Where	Onboard - Modules
What for	See the full module catalogue grouped by category, and edit the modules a particular business is entitled to.

1. Open **Onboard - Modules** to see every module grouped by category (Software & Usage, Support & Assistance, Cloud & Connected Access, Integrations & Advanced Tools).
2. A module with a price is a stand-alone add-on; a module marked Bundled comes with a plan.
3. To change what a shop gets, open the business and select **Edit modules** (or use the business-detail page). Tick/untick modules and select **Save modules**.

> **Notes**
> Editing modules changes the shop's entitlements; the next licence you issue for it will carry the new set.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Module catalogue	GET /api/modules
Add one module	POST /api/businesses/:id/modules/:code
Remove one module	DELETE /api/businesses/:id/modules/:code
Replace the set	POST /api/businesses/:id/modules

Modules & Add-ons

Plans: Basic · Standard · Premium

The full module catalogue. Bundles are defined per plan; extras are quoted as add-ons. Open a business to change what it is entitled to.

SOFTWARE & USAGE

Software Subscription
Core licence to run the app.
Bundled

Offline Billing
Bill and print with no internet.
Bundled

Sales / POS Billing
Counter billing, KOT and printing.
Bundled

Stock & Inventory
Live stock, low-stock alerts, requisitions.
Bundled

Breakage & Leakage
Record breakage against stock.
Bundled

Stock Transfer
Move stock between counters / stores.
Bundled

Excise Sync
State excise registers, audit and Form M-22.
Bundled

Core Reports
Sales, stock, purchase and MIS reports.
Bundled

SUPPORT & ASSISTANCE

AMC Support
Annual maintenance contract support.
Bundled

WhatsApp Support
Support over WhatsApp.
Add-on ₹3,999

Live Chat
In-app live chat with support.
Bundled

CLOUD & CONNECTED ACCESS

Auto Backup
Scheduled automatic backups.
Bundled

Mobile App
Owner mobile app access.
Bundled

Cloud Data
Cloud data and connected services.
Add-on ₹7,999

Web Reporting
Reports over the web.
Bundled

One LAN PC
One extra LAN-connected computer.
Add-on ₹5,999

INTEGRATIONS & ADVANCED TOOLS

Tally Integration
Twin-agent sync to Tally Prime.
Add-on ₹5,999

Attendance System
Staff attendance capture.
Bundled

Antivirus
Managed endpoint antivirus.
Bundled

Lifetime Updates
Free feature updates for life.
Bundled

Advanced Reports
Deep MIS and analytics reports.
Bundled

Camera AI
AI camera monitoring at the counter.
Bundled

Parch Load (AI Purchase Import)
Import wholesale invoices / parchas into purchases.
Add-on ₹5,999

AI Assistant
Assistant for entries, queries and insights.
Bundled

ePOS
Electronic POS integration.
Add-on ₹3,999

Modules & Add-ons: the full catalogue grouped by category.

Part D - Licensing

Issue a licence

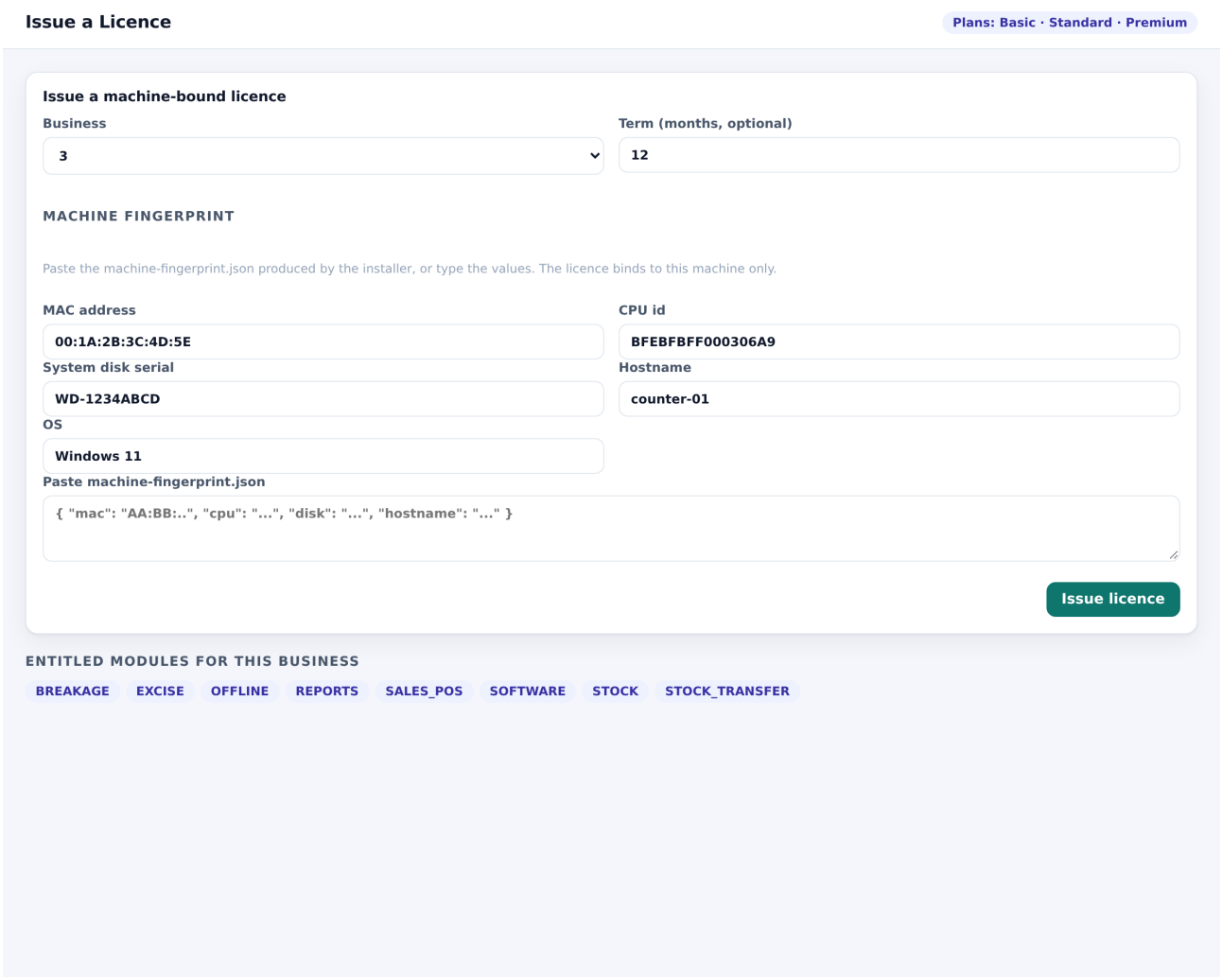
Who	Everyone
Where	Licensing - Issue Licence
What for	Mint a signed `.vlic` licence bound to one machine's fingerprint, for a chosen business and term.

1. Open **Licensing - Issue Licence**.
2. Pick the **Business**. Its entitled modules are listed below the form.
3. Optionally set **Term (months)**; leave blank to use the plan's default term.
4. Under **Machine fingerprint**, paste the `machine-fingerprint.json` from the counter PC (or type the MAC, CPU id, disk serial, hostname and OS).
5. Select **Issue licence**. A dialog shows the new licence id, business, plan, valid dates, machine hash and entitlements.
6. Select **Download licence file** to save the `.vlic`, or **Download payload only** for the unsigned payload JSON.

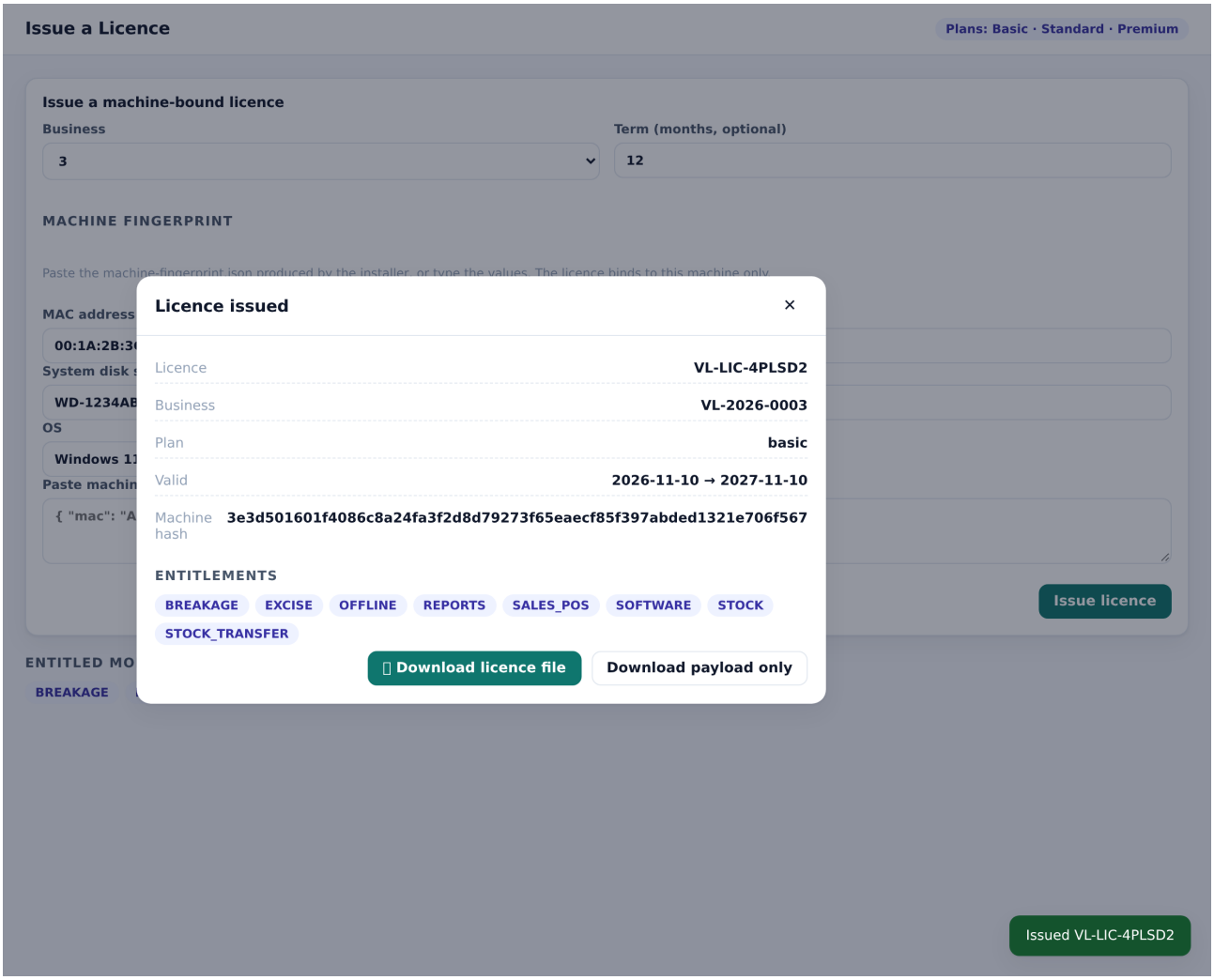
> **Notes**
> The fingerprint must include at least a MAC, CPU id or disk id, otherwise the issue is refused.
> The licence binds to the machine hash, so the same file will not activate on a different PC (anti-clone).
> The licence id looks like `VL-LIC-XXXXXX`.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Issue a licence	POST /api/licenses
Download the .vlic	GET /api/licenses/:id/file



Issue Licence: pick the business, paste the fingerprint, then Issue licence.



The issued-licence dialog with the download buttons.

Activate / Verify a licence

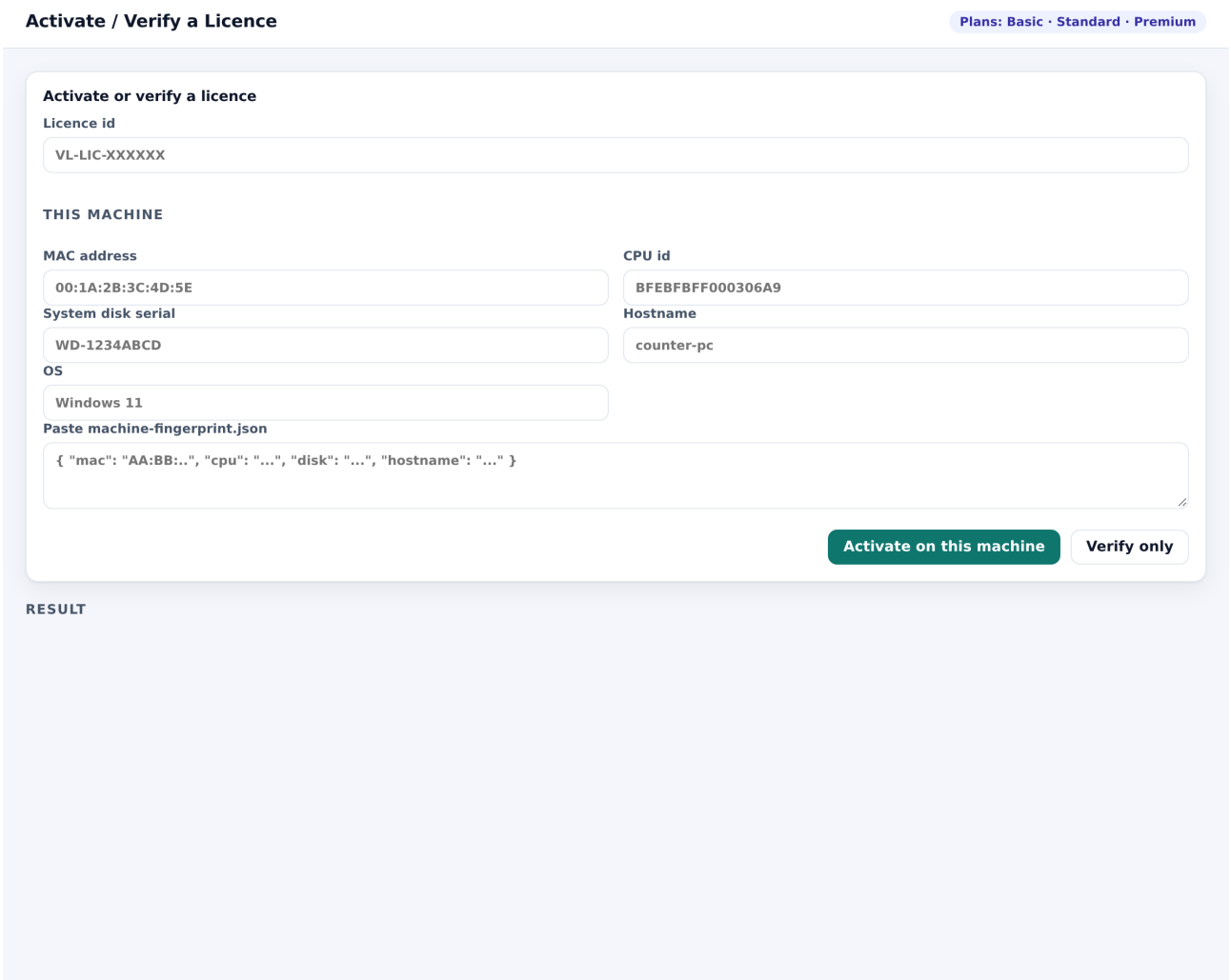
Who	Everyone
Where	Licensing - Activate / Verify
What for	Redeem a licence on the machine it is bound to, or check a licence's validity and machine match.

1. Open **Licensing - Activate / Verify**.
2. Enter the **Licence id** (for example `VL-LIC-XXXXXX`).
3. Enter **This machine**'s fingerprint (paste the JSON or type the fields).
4. Select **Activate on this machine** to redeem it, or **Verify only** to check it without activating.
5. Read the **Result**: a green Licence valid / Activated panel, or a red refusal.

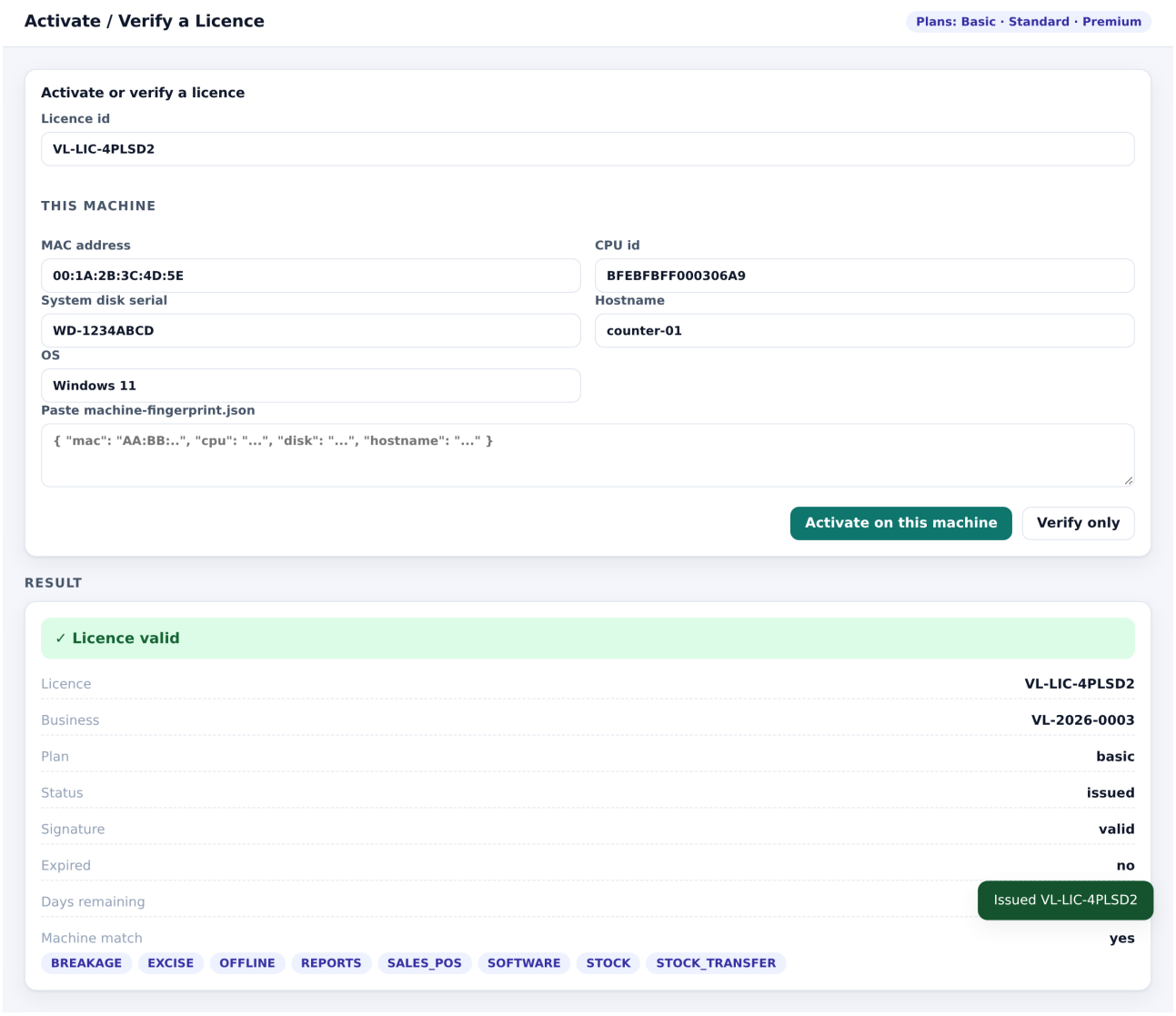
Notes
Activation is refused on a different machine — the message is Licence is bound to a different machine. This is the anti-clone gate.
Verifying checks the Ed25519 signature, the expiry date and (when a fingerprint is given) the machine match. The result shows days remaining and entitlements.
An expired licence, or a revoked one, is refused.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

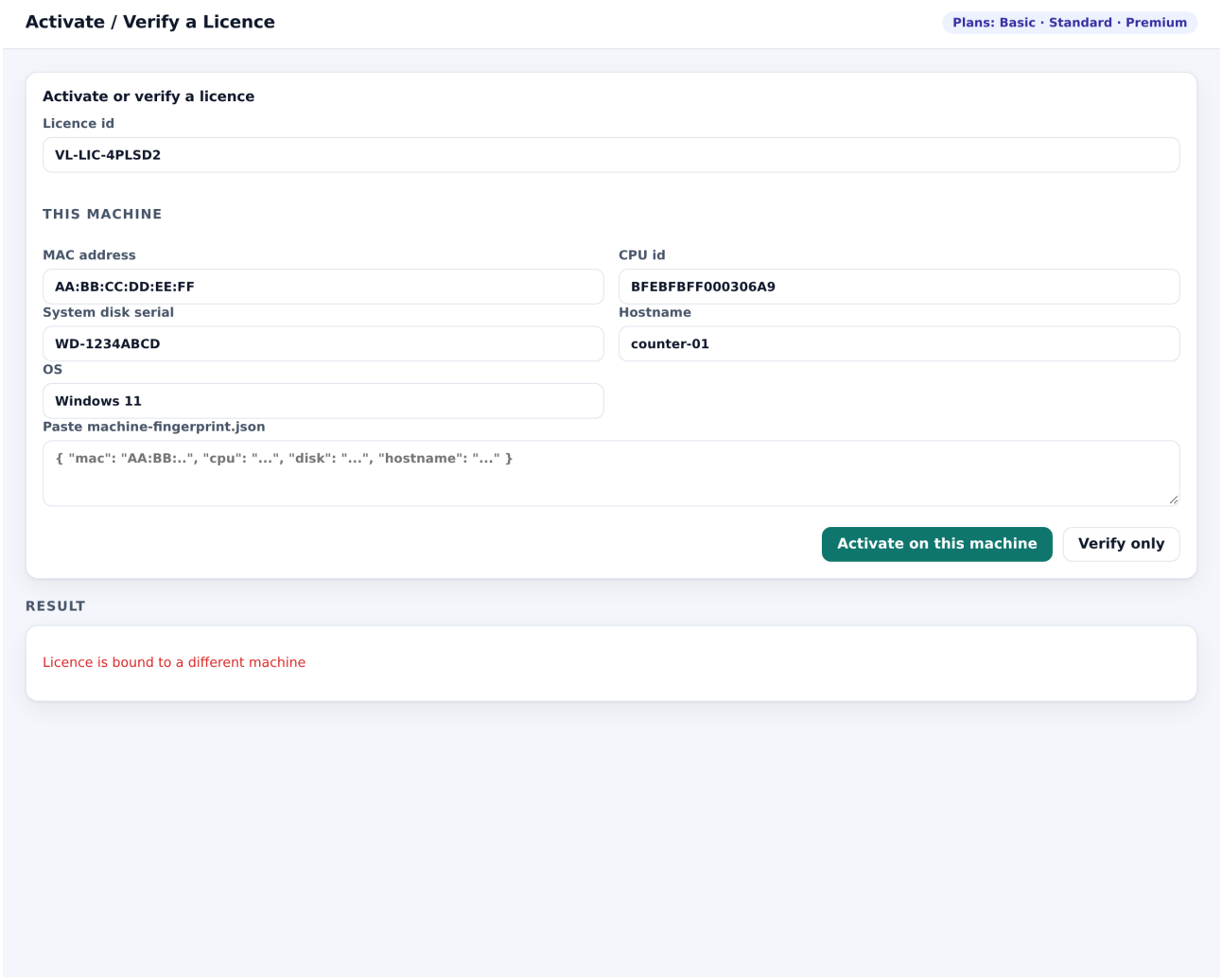
Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Activate	POST /api/licenses/:id/activate
Verify	POST /api/licenses/:id/verify
Activation history	GET /api/licenses/:id/activations
Revoke / re-sign	POST /api/licenses/:id/revoke, /api/licenses/:id/resign



Activate / Verify: enter the licence id and this machine's fingerprint.



Verify only: a valid licence on the correct machine.



Activation refused on a different machine (anti-clone).

Download the App

Who	Everyone
Where	Resources - Download App
What for	Give the counter PC the installer and the fingerprint helper, and explain the end-to-end onboarding flow.

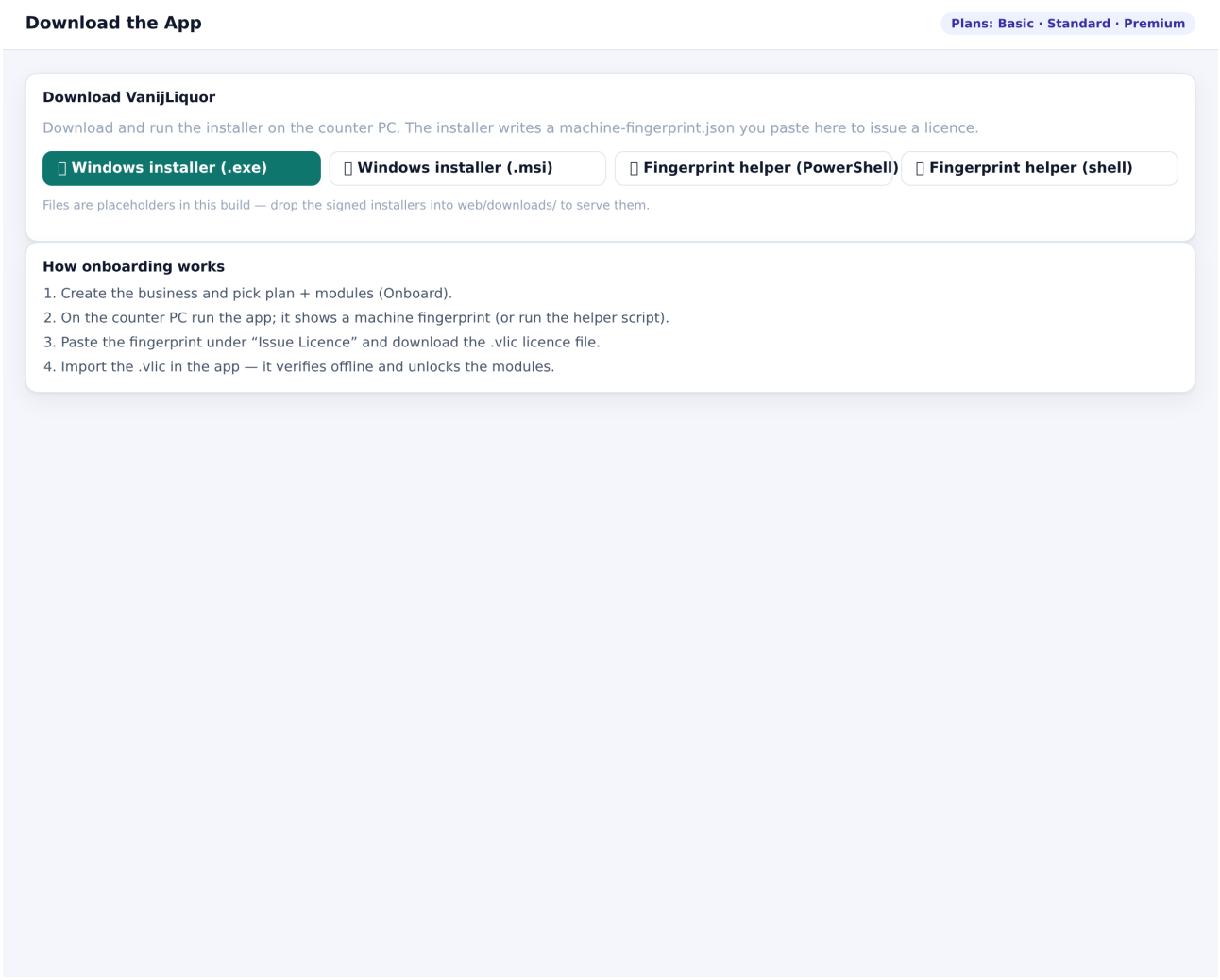
1. Open **Resources - Download App**.
2. Download the **Windows installer** (`.exe` or `.msi`) to run on the counter PC.
3. Download the **fingerprint helper** (PowerShell or shell) if you want to collect the machine fingerprint without the installer.
4. Follow the **How onboarding works** steps on the right of the screen.

> **Notes**
> In this build the installer files are placeholders — drop your signed installers into `web/downloads/` to serve them.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)

Static files	web/downloads/* (served by the web front end)



Download the App: installers, fingerprint helper and the onboarding steps.

Licence signing key

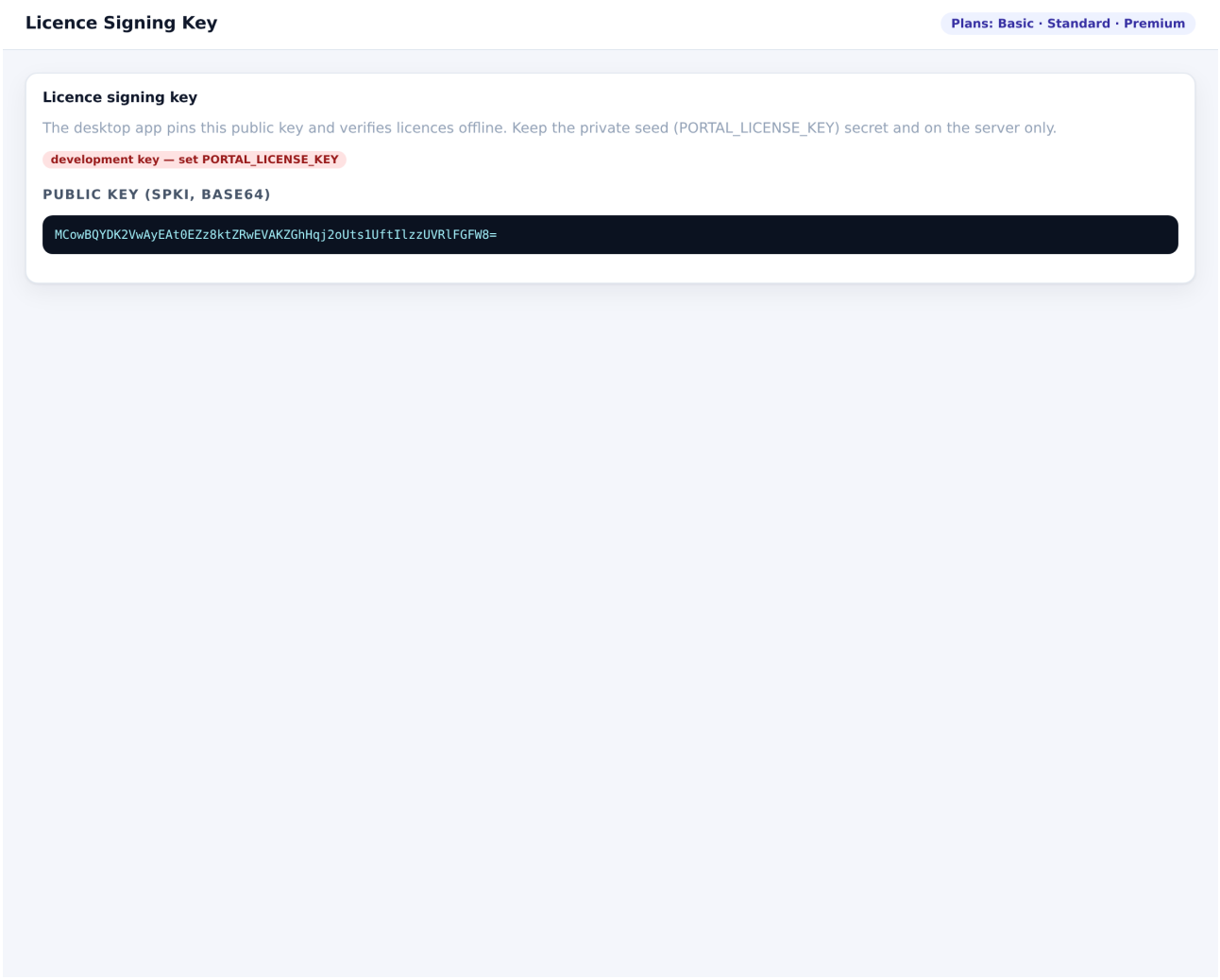
Who	Administrator
Where	Resources - Licence Key
What for	Show the public key the POS app pins, and whether a production signing key is in use.

1. Open **Resources - Licence Key**.
2. Read the badge: **production key in use**, or a warning that a development key is in use.
3. Copy the **Public key (SPKI, base64)** and pin it in the POS app's build so it can verify licences offline.

> **Notes**
> Set `PORTAL_LICENSE_KEY` (the private Ed25519 seed) in the backend environment for production.
> Keep it secret and server-side only.
> Without it, the portal signs with a development key and flags licences as non-production.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Public key + production flag	GET /api/license-key



Licence Key: the pinned public key and the key-mode badge.

Audit Log

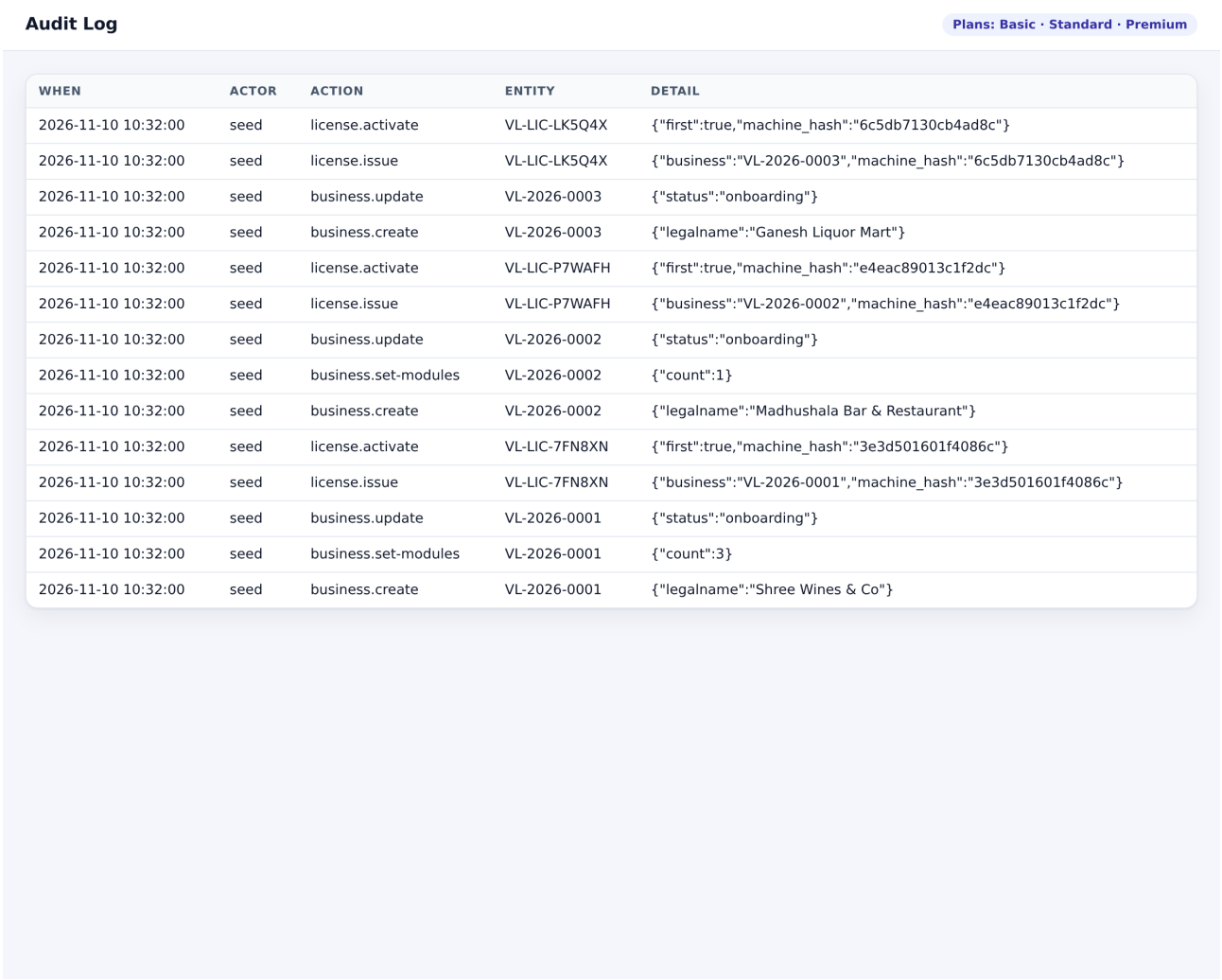
Who	Administrator
Where	Resources - Audit Log
What for	A tamper-evident trail of every portal action: who did what, to which entity, and when.

1. Open **Resources - Audit Log**.
2. Read the table: When, Actor, Action, Entity and Detail.
3. Use it to trace a licence: `license.issue`, `license.activate` and, when someone tries the wrong PC, `license.activate.denied` (with reason `machine-mismatch`).

> **Notes**
> The same recent events appear on the Dashboard. The portal shows the latest 200; the API accepts a `limit`.

Where this lives: portal screen → API routes

Portal screen / action	API route(s)
Recent audit events	GET /api/audit?limit=200



Audit Log: the full action trail.

Part E - Reference

Sample data (demo dataset)

Load it with `npm run seed-demo`. The three demo businesses are listed below; each has a licence activated on its own fingerprint.

Business	Code	Plan / term	Type	City
Shree Wines & Co	VL-2026-0001	Premium / 3 years	retail	Pune
Madhushala Bar & Restaurant	VL-2026-0002	Standard / 1 year	bar	Bengaluru
Ganesh Liquor Mart	VL-2026-0003	Basic / monthly	wholesale	Kolkata

Plans, terms and modules

Three plans, four billing terms. A plan bundles modules; other modules are stand-alone add-ons.

Plan	Monthly	1 year	2 years	3 years
Basic	Rs 499	Rs 5,599	Rs 8,999	Rs 12,999
Standard	Rs 1,199	Rs 12,999	Rs 21,999	Rs 29,999
Premium	Rs 1,499	Rs 15,999	Rs 29,999	Rs 39,999

Add-on	Detail	Price	Period
Cloud	Cloud access and connected data services.	Rs 7,999	Yearly
WhatsApp	WhatsApp integration and support.	Rs 3,999	Yearly
Tally	Automatic Tally accounting synchronisation.	Rs 5,999	Yearly
Purchase Import	Purchase import functionality.	Rs 5,999	One-time
LAN PC	Additional LAN-connected computer.	Rs 5,999	One-time
ePOS	Electronic POS functionality.	Rs 3,999	One-time

Licensing model and anti-clone

A licence is a JSON payload plus a detached **Ed25519** signature. The payload carries the licence id, business, plan, entitlements, the machine hash and the valid dates. The POS app pins the public key and verifies the licence offline.

> **How the machine binding works**
> The installer collects stable identifiers (primary MAC, CPU id, system-disk serial, hostname) and the portal hashes the normalised set with SHA-256 to a `machine_hash`.
> The licence is bound to that hash. Activation on any other machine is refused: Licence is bound to a different machine.
> The hash is one-way, so the licence file leaks nothing reusable.

API reference

The web front end proxies `/api` to the backend. All routes return `{ ok: true, data: ... }` on success.

Portal screen / action	API route(s)

Catalogue	GET /api/health, /api/meta, /api/catalogue, /api/plans, /api/periods, /api/modules, /api/addons, /api/comparison
Quoting	POST /api/quote
Businesses	GET|POST /api/businesses, GET|PUT /api/businesses/:id, POST|DELETE /api/businesses/:id/modules[/:code]
Licences	POST|GET /api/licenses, GET /api/licenses/:id, GET /api/licenses/:id/file
Activation	POST /api/licenses/:id/activate, /verify, /revoke, /resign, GET /api/licenses/:id/activations
Signing key	GET /api/license-key
Portal	GET /api/dashboard, GET /api/audit?limit=

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
Licence is bound to a different machine	The fingerprint does not match the one the licence was issued for. Re-issue the licence with this PC's fingerprint, or activate on the correct PC.
Licence has expired	Issue a fresh licence with a new term from Issue Licence.
Backend unreachable (toast on load)	Start the portal with `npm start`; check the backend is listening on `127.0.0.1:7200`.
Signing key shows development	Set `PORTAL_LICENSE_KEY` to your Ed25519 seed and restart the backend before issuing real licences.
Installers are placeholders	Drop your signed installers into `web/downloads/`.

Where to find things in the repository

Path	Contents
backend/src/server.js	HTTP server and routes
backend/src/services/	onboarding, catalogue, licensing, license (Ed25519), fingerprint, audit, helpers
backend/src/db/	schema.sql, seed.sql (plans, modules, add-ons, comparison)
backend/test/	Test suite (33 tests)
web/	SPA: menu.js (routes), screens.js, api.js, ui.js, app.js, styles.css
web/downloads/	Machine-fingerprint helper scripts (PowerShell + shell)
scripts/	start.js, seed_demo.js, capture_screenshots.js
docs/	This guide and docs/screenshots/